Criterion E: Evaluation

Evaluation of CFS[1]

The final version of FocusGrid was installed on the client's mobile device, and Escher was given time to use it independently before being interviewed a third time. Table 5.1 evaluates the finished application against every Criterion for Success (CFS) item established in Criterion A, alongside the client's feedback on each.

No.	CFS	Status	Client Feedback
1a	Launch screen displays the current month's calendar within 2 seconds, with the navigation bar always visible.	Satisfied. The calendar loads well within the 2-second target on the client's device, and the navigation bar remains visible on every screen.	Escher found the app opened instantly and appreciated always being able to see the navigation bar.
1b	Dark neon UI theme applied consistently across 100% of screens and widgets.	Satisfied. The dark theme and neon accent colours are used consistently across the Home, Add Reminder, Reminder List and Analytics screens.	Escher's team found the theme comfortable to use during their late-night work sessions, exactly as intended.
2a	User can create a reminder with all 6 fields: name, date, time, colour, sound and priority.	Satisfied. All six fields are present on the Add Reminder screen and are saved correctly to Hive.	Escher found the form intuitive and did not need guidance to complete it.
2b	User can add an optional note of up to 250 characters.	Satisfied. The collapsible notes field accepts up to 250 characters and is saved with the reminder.	Escher liked that the notes field could be collapsed, keeping the form uncluttered when not needed.
2c	Missing a mandatory field blocks submission and shows an error within 1 second.	Satisfied. Leaving the name, date, time or priority field empty immediately displays a validation message and prevents saving.	Escher said the error messages were clear and appeared instantly.
2d	Editing a reminder updates the calendar and list views within 1 second, without duplicates.	Satisfied. Edited reminders are updated in place in both views, with no duplicate entries observed during testing.	Escher confirmed that edits appeared immediately wherever the reminder was shown.
2e	Deleting a reminder removes it from local storage immediately.	Satisfied. Deleted reminders no longer appear in any part of the app immediately after the swipe-to-delete action.	Escher found the swipe-to-delete gesture quick and satisfying to use.
3a	Full-month calendar matches the device's system calendar with 100% accuracy.	Satisfied. The TableCalendar widget's dates were cross-checked against the device calendar across three different months with no discrepancies.	Escher did not notice any date errors during her week of independent use.
3b	Days with reminders show a coloured dot matching the reminder's colour label.	Satisfied. Every date with at least one reminder displays dots in the correct colours beneath it.	Escher found it easy to scan the month and instantly recognise which days had which type of task, by colour.

[1] The interview transcript is available in Appendix 3.

No.	CFS	Status	Client Feedback
3c	Tapping a date filters the reminder list to that date in under 1 second.	Satisfied. The list beneath the calendar updates instantly when a new date is tapped.	Escher liked that she no longer had to scroll through a long list to find a specific day's tasks.
4a	All reminders due within 30 days appear in the list, sorted chronologically.	Satisfied. The Reminder List screen displays all upcoming reminders sorted by date then time.	Escher appreciated having one place to see everything coming up, in order.
4b	Each list item displays 5 data points: name, date, time, priority and colour.	Satisfied. Every reminder card shows all five data points clearly.	Escher said the cards gave her enough detail to decide what to act on without opening each one.
4c	Tapping a reminder opens its detail within 1 second, from which it can be edited or deleted.	Satisfied. Tapping a card opens the Add Reminder screen pre-filled with that reminder's data almost instantly.	Escher found editing a existing reminder just as simple as creating a new one
5a	The app lists every free slot of at least 30 minutes between 08:00 and 20:00 on the selected day.	Satisfied. The free-slot detection algorithm correctly identified all qualifying gaps during testing with varied reminder patterns.	Escher found the suggestions surprisingly accurate and said it helped her spot gaps she would otherwise have missed.
5b	A free-slot suggestion message is shown when 0 reminders exist for the selected day.	Satisfied. An empty day correctly displays a prompt suggesting the client add reminders.	Escher liked the gentle nudge on days she had not yet planned.
6a	A push notification is delivered within 60 seconds of the scheduled time, with 100% reliability while permissions are granted.	Satisfied. All test notifications arrived within the 60-second window across a range of scheduled times.	Escher confirmed notifications always arrived on time and never felt delayed.
6b	Each notification shows the reminder name and up to the first 100 characters of its notes.	Satisfied. Notification bodies correctly display the reminder name followed by a truncated preview of any notes.	Escher said the notification previews gave her enough context to know whether something was urgent, without opening the app.

Table 5.1: CFS Evaluation

Recommendations for Improvement

The application designed proved to be working properly and fulfilled all requirements from the list of the Criteria for Success of the client. Nonetheless, there are some ways how the efficiency of the software can be increased.

Firstly, the synchronisation with Google Calendar is now one-sided. The reminders added or modified within FocusGrid are added to Google Calendar, but any changes made in Google Calendar itself cannot be pulled back into FocusGrid. Two-way sync can be achieved via Google Calendar API incremental sync tokens which will help to detect any changes outside of the application.

Secondly, the current interface of the software comes only with one dark neon colour scheme. Although this colour scheme was convenient for Escher's team, providing the possibility to choose several colour schemes or to add the accent colour can make the application more versatile and popular without lowering its legibility.

Thirdly, the logic for saving a reminder is duplicated across the create and edit code paths in AddReminderScreen, since both branches independently write to Hive, schedule a notification, and sync to Google Calendar. Refactoring this into a single shared saveAndSyncReminder() method, called by both paths with different arguments, would reduce code duplication and the risk of one path being updated without the other in future maintenance.

Extensibility

One potential extension of this application would be to allow reminders to be shared across a CodeNest team, rather than remaining private to a single device. Since the original problem Escher described was fragmented visibility across teammates, a shared “workspace” Hive box, synced via a lightweight backend, would let colleagues see and coordinate around each other's reminders directly within FocusGrid, rather than relying solely on the shared Google Calendar.

Another extension would be voice-based reminder creation, using on-device speech-to-text to let a user dictate a reminder's name, date and time hands-free. This would be particularly useful during the kind of client calls Escher described, where quickly noting a follow-up task without breaking eye contact to type would save time and reduce the chance of a commitment being forgotten.